AUTNES
AUSTRIAN NATIONAL ELECTION STUDY

AUTNES Online Panel Study 2017–2024 Documentation

(v2.0)

AUTNES Online Panel Study 2017–2024 – Documentation
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Suggested citation for the data:
Partheymüller, Julia, Julian Aichholzer, Sylvia Kritzinger, Markus Wagner, Carolina Plescia, Jakob-Moritz Eberl, Thomas Meyer, Hajo Boomgaarden and Wolfgang C. Müller (2024). *AUTNES Online Panel Study 2017–2024*. Vienna: AUSSDA (doi: https://doi.org/10.11587/HNUFCC).

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1 Introduction

This report accompanies the Online Panel Study 2017–2024 (https://doi.org/10.11587/HNUFCC), conducted by the Austrian National Election Study (AUTNES), and provides detailed documentation of the data collection process. The multi-wave panel covers the Austrian National Parliamentary Election on 15 October 2017, the European Parliament Election on 26 May 2019, the Austrian National Parliamentary Election on 29 September 2019, the Presidential Election on 9 October 2022, the European Parliament Election on 9 June 2024, and the Austrian National Parliamentary Election on 29 September 2024. Tracking Austrian voters' attitudes, perceptions, and voting behavior across these elections, the study offers valuable insights into the the dynamics of Austrian public opinion.

1.1 How to cite these data

Data users are kindly asked to acknowledge the data and the accompanying release document (Documentation):

Suggested citation for the data:
Partheymüller, Julia, Julian Aichholzer, Sylvia Kritzinger, Markus Wagner, Carolina Plescia, Jakob-Moritz Eberl, Thomas Meyer, Hajo Boomgaarden and Wolfgang C. Müller (2024). *AUTNES Online Panel Study 2017–2024*. Vienna: AUSSDA (doi: https://doi.org/10.11587/HNUFCC).

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1.2 Changes in Editions

(No changes.)

2 Conditions of Use

2.1 Restrictions

The data are available for scientific use without restrictions.

2.2 Confidentiality

The AUTNES research team and the funding institutions neither take responsibility for the use of the data or interpretations and inferences based on their use, nor do they accept liability for indirect, consequential, or incidental damages or losses arising from use of the data.

2.3 Deposit Requirement

In order to facilitate exchange within the scientific community and to provide the funding agencies with essential information about the use of archival resources, users of the AUTNES data are asked to notify the AUTNES team of publications based on its data.

3 Study Description

3.1 Title and Edition

AUTNES Online Panel Study 2017–2024 – Documentation (Edition 2.0)

3.2 Research Team

Sylvia Kritzinger & Julia Partheymüller, Department of Government, University of Vienna (Demand Side)
Hajo Boomgaarden & Jakob-Moritz Eberl, Department of Communication, University of Vienna (Media Side)
Laurenz Ennser-Jedenastik & Thomas Meyer, Department of Government, University of Vienna (Supply Side)

3.3 Funding / Acknowledgments

Data collection for the elections 2017 and 2019 was funded by ACIER – *Austrian Cooperative Infrastructure for Electoral Research* financed by the Federal Ministry of Science, Research and Economy (BMWFW) [Scheme: Hochschulraum-Strukturmittel 2016]. Data collection from 2022 onwards was made possible thanks to the cooperative *Digitize!* project, funded by the Federal Ministery of Education, Science, and Research (BMBWF).

3.4 Fieldwork agency

The fieldwork for the AUTNES Online Panel Study 2017–2024 was completed by "Marketagent.com online reSEARCH GmbH" (Baden, Austria), URL: https://www.marketagent.com/

3.5 File Names

10874_mr_en_v2_0.pdf (Method Report)
10874_om_en_v2_0.tab (Appendix including Variable List and Table A1)
10874_qu_de_v2_0.pdf (Questionnaire German)
10874_qu_en_v2_0.pdf (Questionnaire English)
10874_da_de_v2_0.dta (Stata Data File German)
10874_da_en_v2_0.dta (Stata Data File English)
10874_da_de_v2_0.sav (SPSS Data File German)
10874_da_en_v2_0.sav (SPSS Data File English)

3.6 Topics / Keywords

politics, voting, elections, Austria

4 Study Design

4.1 Sampling

The AUTNES 2017–2024 Online Panel Study is a multi-wave online panel survey. The survey respondents were recruited from a commercial online access pool maintained by Marketagent, Austria. In order to participate in the 2017 surveys respondents had to be eligible to vote on Election Day 2017 (Austrian citizens and at least 16 years old). Respondents were selected (quota sample) based on the following key demographics: age, gender, gender X age, region (province), educational level, household size, and population size based on census data (Statistics Austria, StatCube). The quotas were structured in such a way as to match the Austrian population as closely as possible. Please note that due to the online mode of the survey, only citizens with internet access were able to participate in the study and that some demographics remain hard-to-reach online.

The 2017 panelists were reinvited in 2019. In addition, fresh respondents were recruited based on quotas as before. In order to participate, new respondents had to be eligible to vote at the 2019 European Parliament election. From Wave 11 onwards, we also allowed fresh respondents to enter the survey who were eligible to vote for at the 2019 Austrian National Parliamentary Election, which took place a few months later.

In 2022, all respondents who had took part in at least one survey wave in 2019/2020 (Wave 7 to 13) were reinvinted for participation. Again, fresh repondents were recruited based on representative quotas to compensate for panel dropouts. The target population this time were all Austrian citizens eligible to vote by the end of November 2022.

In November 2023, all respondents that had participated at least once since Wave 7 were re-invited to participate again. Fresh repondents were recruited based on representative quotas to compensate for panel dropouts. The target population this time were all Austrian citizens eligible to vote by the end of September 2024.

We present a comparison of the target population and different waves according to core demographic characteristics in the accompanying Excel table (see Table A1 in the Appendix).

4.2 Field Work

The fieldwork was conducted by Marketagent within the following periods (see Table 1). Table 1 also provides the average interview length.

Table 1. Fieldwork and interview length

Wave #	Fieldwork period	Interview length (in min.)
Wave 1	6 Jun. 2017 – 14 Jun. 2017	[21] / 22
Wave 2	26 Jul. 2017 – 10 Aug. 2017	[20] / 21
Wave 3	30 Aug. 2017 – 14 Sept. 2017	[20] / 21
Wave 4	2 Oct. 2017 – 13 Oct. 2017	[21] / 22, *[33] / *31
15 Oct. 2017: Austrian National Parliamentary Elections		
Wave 5	17 Oct. 2017 – 27 Oct. 2017	[14] / 16
Wave 6	14 Dec. 2017 – 29 Dec. 2017	[15] / 16, *[19] / *20
Wave 7	25 Feb. 2019 – 12 Mar. 2019	[25] / 24
Wave 8	12 Apr. 2019 – 28. Apr. 2019	[23] / 23, *[25]/*25
Wave 9	6 May 2019 – 25 May 2019	[15] / 16, *[23]/*23
26 May 2019: European Parliament Elections		
Wave 10	27 May 2019 – 16 Jun. 2019	[25] / 25, *[30] / *28
Wave 11	9 Sept. 2019 – 28 Sept. 2019	[22] / 23, *[29] / *28
29 Sept. 2019: Austrian National Parliamentary Elections		
Wave 12	30 Sept. 2019 – 11 Oct. 2019	[24] / 23, *[29] / *26
Wave 13	10 Jan. 2020 – 24 Jan. 2020	[19] / 19, *[21] / *21
Wave 14	3 Jun. 2022 – 21 Jun. 2022	[20] / 20
9. Oct. 2022: Austrian Presidential Elections		
Wave 15	10 Oct. 2022 – 26 Oct. 2022	[15] / 16, *[20] / *20
Wave 16	10 Nov. 2023 – 6 Dec. 2023	[18] / 18
Wave 17	26 Jan. 2024 – 20 Feb. 2024	[17] / 18, *[20] / *21
Wave 18	15 Mar. 2024 – 7 Apr. 2024	[18] / 18, *[22] / *22
Wave 19	13 May 2024 – 8 Jun. 2024	[16] / 17, *[20] / *20
9 June 2024: European Parliament Elections		
Wave 20	10 Jun. 2024 – 25 Jun. 2024	[16] / 17, *[24] / *24
Wave 21	26 Jul. 2024 – 20. Aug. 2024	[16] / 17, *[20] /*19
Wave 22	2 Sept. 2024 – 28. Sept. 2024	[20] / 20, *[22] / *21
29 Sept. 2024: Austrian National Parliamentary Elections		
Wave 23	30 Sept. 2024 – 13 Oct. 2024	[23] / 23, *[30] /*27
Wave 24	3 Mar. 2025 – 27 Mar. 2025	[29] / 27, *[29] /*26

(*Note:* Interview length denotes [median] / mean, excluding interviews > 60 min, *fresh respondents)

4.3 Initial recruitment and panel participation

Respondents were initially invited to the study in June 2017 and recruited based on quotas for age, gender, education, region and hoursehold size. Respondents were received and incentive of 2€ for the completion of each panel wave.

In 2017 (Waves 1-6), fresh respondents to compensate for dropouts were only recruited in Wave 4 and Wave 6. After that, fresh respondents were continuously recruited at every panel wave to ensure a sufficient representativeness of the sample. In 2019/20 (Waves 7-13), all participants who had taken part in at least one of the first sixth waves were re-invited to participate in each wave and dropouts were compensated for by recruiting fresh respondents. In the period from 2022 to 2025 (Wave s14-24), all participants who had taken part in at least one panel wave since 2019/20 were reinvited to take part in the study once again.

Table 2 shows that gross sample sizes and response rates per wave. Response rates are only seemingly lower in consecutive waves in the 2019/20 panel because of the inclusion of 2017 panelists in the calculation, who never rejoined the panel after taking part in the 2017 study (Waves 1-6). A similar effect applies to 2022 to 2025 (Waves 14-24) as some of the panelists were already no longer active by the end of the 2019/20 study.

The variables **panelpat** and **w*_panelist** inform about the individual pattern of panel participation and participation in each wave, respectively.

Table 2. Sample sizes and response rates

	W1	W2	W3	W4	W5	W6	W7	W8	W9	W10	W11	W12	W13	W14	W15	W16	W17	W18	W19	W20	W21	W22	W23	W24	
Gross samples sizes (incl. cases excluded ex-post)																									
n responded (incl. cases deleted ex-post)	4103	3183	3035	3224	3109	3101	3144	3222	3266	3118	3054	3147	3166	3259	3246	3194	3146	3122	3110	3189	3220	3133	3262	3169	
n responded from prev. waves		3183	3035	2908	3109	2935	2214	2521	3126	2926	2900	3040	2922	1946	2656	2406	2842	2748	2674	2785	3007	2876	2857	2807	
n responded fresh invites	4103			316		166	930	701	140	192	203	107	244	1287	590	788	304	437	436	404	213	257	383	362	
Resp. from prev. waves contacted (invites)		4103	4103	4103	4103	4103	4195	3128	5025	5126	5731	5904	4638	4585	5720	6032	6621	6828	7196	7593	7944	8073	8230	8282	
Fresh Resp. contacted (invites)	45341			3590		316	19239	7351	817	4607	8557	2957	10323	32004	21190	31535	19678	30443	42790	44975	27549	39373	41126	37059	
Response rates																									
RR Resp. from prev. waves (%)		77.6	74.0	70.9	75.8	71.5	52.8	80.6	62.2	57.1	50.6	51.5	63.0	42.4	56.7	39.9	42.9	40.2	37.2	36.7	37.9	35.6	34.7	33.9	
RR Fresh invited Resp.(%)	9.0			8.8		52.5	4,8	9.5	17.1	4.2	2.3	3.6	2.4	4.0	2.8	2.5	1.5	1.4	1.0	0.9	0.7	0.7	0.9	1.0	
n excluded ex-post (fieldwork company criteria)	61	26	16	37	54	21	16	68	61	57	51	78	103	26	52	17	17	24	0	0	82	93	138	32	
n excluded ex-post (socio-demographic checks)																									134
n excluded (non-eligible resp.)																									91
n finally used (without excl. cases)	3987	3110	2968	3133	3004	2967	3071	3101	3141	3001	3000	3084	3006	3078	3050	3112	3002	3038	3050	3129	3078	2984	3074	2978	
Total sample																									**11472**

Note: In W8 we cannot differentiate invites of 2017 panelists from fresh respondents; the response rate for fresh respondents therefore gets inflated.

5 Data Cleaning

5.1 Variable list

A full list of variables included in the dataset, along with their descriptions, is available in the accompanying material in the data repository.

5.2 Data protection

All information on postal codes (**sd25, sd25_y19, sd25_y22, sd25_y24**), political districts (**poldis, poldis_y19, poldis_y22**) and the regional constituency (**regwk, regwk_y19, regwk_y22, regwk_y24**) were removed from the data set for reasons of data protection. However, postal codes were used to add the categorized population number of the municipality (**popnum, popnum_y19, popnum_y22, popnum_y24**) to the data set.

We also removed the date of birth (**sd2x1, sd2x1_y19, sd2x1_y22, sd2x1_y24**). However, a variable capturing the age of the respondent on Election Day is available in the data set (**age, age_y19, age_y22, age_y24**).

Morevover, we removed the names of political discussants from the data file and replaced them with numerical id variables (**w2_q44t_id, w2_q45x1t_id, w2_q45x2t_id, w4_q77t_id, w4_q78x1t_id, w4_q78x2t_id, w6_q45t_id, w6_q46x2t_id, w6_q46x1t_id**) to anonymize the data.

Finally, we recoded the following variables for reasons of data protection:

Variable	Variable Label	Original Values	Recoded Version
sd7 **sd7_y19** **sd7_y22** **sd7_y24**	HIGHEST LEVEL OF EDUCATION	1 Did not attend school 2 Did not finish any school 3 Primary school or less 4 Lower secondary school / AHS lower level 5 Special school 6 Polytechnic institute 7 Vocational training/school 8 Vocational middle school 9 AHS with diploma 10 BHS with diploma 11 University-related college 12 College 13 Bachelor 14 Magister/Master 15 Doctorate/PhD 16 other	3 Did not attend/finish school/primary school or less 4 Lower secondary school / AHS lower level 6 polytechnic institute 7 Vocational training/school 8 Vocational middle school 9 AHS with diploma 10 BHS with diploma 11 University-related college 12 College 13 Bachelor 14 Magister/Master 15 Doctorate/PhD 16 other
sd8 **sd8_y19** **sd8_y22** **sd8_y24**	RELIGIOUS AFFILIATION	1 Roman-Catholic church 2 Protestant church 3 Islamic religious community 4 Islamic-Alevi religious community 5 Christian-orthodox church 6 Jewish religious community 7 other 8 none	1 Roman-Catholic church 2 Protestant church 3 Islamic religious community 5 Christian-orthodox church 7 other 8 none
sd18 **sd18_y19** **sd18_y22** **sd18_y24**	Country of birth, respondent	1 Austria 2 Germany 3 Turkey 4 Serbia 5 Croatia 6 Bosnia 7 Slovenia 8 Poland	1 Austria 2 Germany 3 Bosnia, Croatia, Serbia 4 Poland, Slovenia, Czech Republic, Hungary 5 Other country

Variable	Variable Label	Original Values	Recoded Version
		9 Czech Republic 10 Russia 11 Hungary 12 other country	
sd19 **sd19_y19** **sd19_y22** **sd19_y24**	Country of birth, mother	1 Austria 2 Germany 3 Turkey 4 Serbia 5 Croatia 6 Bosnia 7 Slovenia 8 Poland 9 Czech Republic 10 Russia 11 Hungary 12 other country	1 Austria 2 Germany 3 Turkey 4 Bosnia, Croatia, Serbia 5 Poland, Slovenia, Czech Republic, Hungary 6 Other country
sd20 **sd20_y19** **sd20_y22** **sd20_y24**	Country of birth	1 Austria 2 Germany 3 Turkey 4 Serbia 5 Croatia 6 Bosnia 7 Slovenia 8 Poland 9 Czech Republic 10 Russia 11 Hungary 12 other country	1 Austria 2 Germany 3 Turkey 4 Bosnia, Croatia, Serbia 5 Poland, Slovenia, Czech Republic, Hungary 6 Other country
w23_q11 **w24f_q43**	Vote choice: National Election 2024	1 OEVP 2 SPOE 3 FPOE 4 GREENS 5 NEOS 6 KPOE 7 BEER PARTY 8 KEINE/Change 9 List Petrovic 10 List GAZA 11 MFG 12 The Yellow 77 voted invalid 88 don't know 99 refused	1 OEVP 2 SPOE 3 FPOE 4 GREENS 5 NEOS 6 KPOE 7 BEER PARTY 66 other party 77 voted invalid 88 don't know 99 refused

5.3 Quality assurance and excluded respondents

We excluded some cases due to quality issues.

1.) Respondents were excluded who exhibited very short response times (interview duration) as well as aberrant response patterns (straight-lining) as identified by the fieldwork company Marketagent. The numbers of cases are listed in Table 4.
2.) Respondents were excluded if the year of birth of the respondent deviated by 2 years (or more) and if gender of the respondent changed (at least once) within one electoral cycle (2017, 2019, 2022-2025). Cases were deleted if both conditions applied (see Table 4).
3.) By mistake n = 23 non-citizens and n = 4 respondents below the age of 16 were included in the fresh sample of wave 6 (in total n = 27), but were not interviewed. These cases were excluded.
4.) Additionally, there were n = 2 respondents with values for age in years > 100. These were defined as missing in age (recoded as = .).

5.) One respondent entered an implausibly large value for the variable household size (sd5). The entry was recoded to missing.

The dataset also includes attention check questions (**w1_q27x5**, **w2_q24x5, w14_q29x5, w15f_q32x5 w23_q46x5)**, which could be used to identify respondents with lower response quality. However, we refrained from excluding respondents who failed these attention check questions.

5.4 Variable format and missing values

All standard socio demographic variables (both for panel and fresh respondents) are designated by **sd*** (2017)**, sd*_y19** (2019), **sd*_y22** (2022), and **sd*_y24** (2023/4).

All other questions have the following standard format:

Table 1. Format of variable names

	Wave #	fresh respondents	question #	item #	text/string
abbreviation	w*	f	_q*	x*	t
example	2		24	5	
			= **w2_q24x5**		

For most variables missing values were coded as follows:

77 = do not know party/person
88 = don't know
99 = refused

5.5 Post-hoc harmonization of variables

To ensure consistent and comparable coding across all panel waves, the coding of the following variables was harmonized post-hoc. This harmonization aims to facilitate the seamless integration and merging of voting behavior information across multiple survey waves.

Variable label:
VOTE CHOICE: NATIONAL ELECTION 2019

List of variable names:
w12_q12, w13f_q30, w14_q22, w15f_q31, w16_q23, w17f_q18, w18f_q13, w19f_q40, w20f_q38, w21f_q30, w22f_q28, w23f_q43

Harmonized coding scheme:
The variables were coded consistently as follows:

Code	Label
1	OEVP
2	SPOE
3	FPOE
4	NEOS
5	JETZT - List Pilz
6	Greens
7	KPOE
8	WANDEL
11	Other Party
12	Voted Invalid
88	Don't Know
99	No Answer

5.6 Semi-open questions and coding

The variables **w17_q10** (PARTY CHOICE: VOTE INTENTION), **w18_q40**, and **w18_q41** (PARTY CHOICE: PROSPECTIVE - EUROPEAN PARLIAMENTARY ELECTION 2024; PARTY CHOICE: HYPOTHETICAL - EUROPEAN PARLIAMENTARY ELECTION 2024) were collected using a semi-open question format. Respondents selected from a list of predefined parties, with an "OTHER PARTY" option available for open-ended responses. These open-ended answers were coded and incorporated into the variables. Notably, the BEER PARTY and KPOE were frequently mentioned in the open responses, prompting their inclusion as additional categories to enable meaningful comparisons in subsequent survey waves.

6 Weighting of data

The dataset includes several weighting variables, which can be used for post-stratification adjustment to known population distributions. For all waves two weighting variables are provided:

- demographic weight: **w*_weightd**
  The "demographic" weight adjusts to known socio-demographic population distributions only (see Table A1 in the Appendix).
- demographic + political weight: **w*_weightp**
  The "political" weight further adjusts for turnout and vote choice marginals using reported voting behavior in the last national election (2013/2017/2019/2024) or last European Parliament election (2019/2024), respectively (see also Table A1 in the Appendix).

Target distributions are based on Micro Census data 2017, 2019, 2021 and 2023 (Statistics Austria StatCube) using the Austrian population aged ≥ 15 having Austrian citizenship as reference population. Official election results are provided by the Austrian Ministry of the Interior.

For computing the weighting variables, we used the Stata module "ipfweight". Computation of all weighting variables was limited to a minimum value of 0.20 and a maximum value of 5.00. Missing values in the target variables were weighted neutrally.